

Word family: **busy** / busier / busiest / busily

Base word: busy

Comparative: busier

Superlative: busiest

Related form: busily

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / adverb (相關形式)

Your phrase:

> “a packed train, a **busy** café, and a noisy office”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **busy** describes the café.

Meaning: Having many customers and a lot of activity happening at the same time.

繁體中文: 有很多顧客進出、員工不停工作，整個地方活動頻繁而繁忙的

中文翻譯:

> “a packed train, a **busy** café, and a noisy office”

「一列擠滿乘客的火車、一間**顧客很多、活動頻繁而繁忙的咖啡店**，以及一個嘈吵的辦公室」

busy café = 顧客很多，而且點餐、交談、服務等活動持續進行的繁忙咖啡店

1. **busy = person (人) having many things to do — 忙碌的; 有很多事情要處理的**

Meaning: Occupied with work, tasks, or activities and therefore having little free time.

Practice 1

> “I’m **busy** this afternoon.”

「我今天下午**有很多事情要處理，沒有多少空閒時間**。」

Practice 2

> “She is always **busy** at the end of the month.”

「她每逢月底都**工作很多，非常忙碌**。」

busy person = 有大量工作、任務或活動需要處理，因此沒有多少空閒時間的人

2. **busy doing + activity (正在進行的事情) — 正忙於做.....**

Meaning: Actively occupied with a particular activity.

Practice 3

> “She was **busy preparing** for the presentation.”

「她當時正**忙於準備簡報**。」

Practice 4

> “The staff are **busy serving** customers.”

「員工正**忙著招待顧客**。」

busy doing something = 當時主要時間和注意力都用於進行某項活動

3. **busy with + work/task (工作／事情) — 忙於處理.....**

Meaning: Having a particular task, project, or type of work occupying your time.

Practice 5

> “I’m **busy with** a new project at the moment.”

「我目前正**忙於處理一個新專案**。」

Practice 6

> “He has been **busy with** paperwork all morning.”

「他整個早上都**忙於處理文書工作**。」

busy with something = 時間和精力被某項工作或事情大量佔用

4. **busy** = place/business (地方／商店／餐廳) having many people and much activity — 人多、活動頻繁而繁忙的

This is the meaning in your original sentence.

Meaning: Having many customers, visitors, workers, or activities happening.

Practice 7 — Original

> “a packed train, a **busy** café, and a noisy office”

「一列擠滿乘客的火車、一間顧客很多、活動頻繁的繁忙咖啡店，以及一個嘈吵的辦公室」

Practice 8

> “The restaurant is always **busy** at lunchtime.”

「這間餐廳午餐時間總是顧客很多、店內活動非常繁忙。」

Practice 9

> “The airport was extremely **busy** during the holiday period.”

「假期期間，機場旅客很多，各項活動十分繁忙。」

busy place = 有很多人及活動持續進行，整體運作十分繁忙的地方

5. **busy** = road/street/transport route (道路／街道／交通路線) having a lot of traffic — 車流／人流頻繁的；交通繁忙的

Meaning: Used by many vehicles or people.

Practice 10

> “Be careful when crossing this **busy** road.”

「過這條車流量很大、交通繁忙的道路時要小心。」

Practice 11

> “The hotel is located on a **busy** street.”

「酒店位於一條**車輛和行人來往頻繁的街道**上。」

****busy road/street = 車輛或行人流量很大、交通活動頻繁的****

6. ****busy = period/day/season (時段／日子／季節) containing a lot of work or activity — 工作或活動很多的繁忙時段****

****Meaning:** A period during which many things happen or much work must be done.**

Practice 12

> “Monday was a very ****busy**** day.”

「星期一是****工作和活動安排很多、非常繁忙的一天****。」

Practice 13

> “December is our ****busiest**** time of year.”

「十二月是我們一年中****工作量最大、最繁忙的時期****。」

****busy period = 在某段時間內工作、顧客、活動或需求特別多的****

This is closely related to a ****busy person**** but the subject is the ****time period****, not the individual.

7. ****busy = schedule/calendar (時間表／日程) containing many appointments or activities — 行程排得很滿的****

****Meaning:** Having many appointments, meetings, or planned activities.**

Practice 14

> “I have a ****busy**** schedule this week.”

「我這星期的****行程安排很多，時間相當緊密****。」

Practice 15

> “It’s going to be a ****busy**** morning with four meetings.”

「早上有四個會議，所以會是個****行程很多、相當繁忙的上午****。」

****busy schedule = 安排了很多工作或活動, 空閒時間較少的日程****

This overlaps with #6, so I would regard them as ****one broader time-related concept****, but they are useful separate contexts for learning.

8. ****busy = phone line(電話線) already being used — 佔線的; 正在通話中的****

****Meaning:**** A telephone line is currently in use, so another call cannot connect.

Practice 16

> “I tried to call her, but the line was ****busy****.”

「我嘗試打電話給她, 但電話****正在佔線, 無法接通****。」

Practice 17

> “The number was ****busy**** every time I called.”

「我每次打過去, 電話號碼都****正在通話中／佔線****。」

****busy line = 電話線正在被使用, 因此其他來電暫時無法接通****

In British English, ****engaged**** is also commonly used:

> “The line is engaged.”

= 「電話佔線。」

9. ****busy = machine/system/server(機器／系統／伺服器) currently occupied handling another task or heavy demand — 正在處理工作而暫時無法接受更多操作的****

****Meaning:**** A device or computer system is already processing work or receiving heavy demand.

Practice 18

> “The server is ****busy****. Please try again later.”

「伺服器目前****正在處理大量工作, 暫時無法接受更多要求****, 請稍後再試。」

Practice 19

> “The printer is **busy** processing another job.”

「打印機正**處理**另一項打印工作，暫時未能執行新的工作**。**」

busy system/device = 系統或設備正被其他工作佔用，暫時沒有可用處理能力

This is the technological extension of the same idea as a **busy person**: something is already occupied.

10. **busy** = design/pattern/page (設計／圖案／版面) containing too many visual elements — 視覺元素過多、顯得雜亂繁複的

This is an important figurative use.

Meaning: Having so many colours, shapes, details, or elements that the design looks crowded or difficult to process visually.

Practice 20

> “The website looks too **busy**.”

「這個網站**視覺元素太多**，版面顯得雜亂而難以閱讀**。**」

Practice 21

> “The pattern is a little **busy** for such a small room.”

「對這麼小的房間來說，這個圖案**細節和視覺元素太多**，顯得過於繁複**。**」

busy design = 畫面中同時存在過多細節、顏色或元素，使視覺效果顯得太滿或雜亂

This is very similar to the broader figurative **crowded** sense we curated earlier.

11. **busier / busiest** = comparative and superlative forms — 更繁忙的／最繁忙的

Because **busy** ends in **-y**:

* busy

* **busier**

* **busiest**

Practice 22

> “The café is **busier** on weekends.”

「這間咖啡店週末**顧客更多、更加繁忙**。」

Practice 23

> “Friday is usually our **busiest** day.”

「星期五通常是我們**工作量最大、最繁忙的一天**。」

12. **busily** = in an active, occupied way — **忙碌地; 不停地做事**

Meaning: In a way that shows someone is actively occupied with work or another activity.

Practice 24

> “The staff were **busily** preparing the café for lunch.”

「員工正**忙碌地**為午餐時段作準備。」

Practice 25

> “She typed **busily** at her desk.”

「她坐在桌前**忙個不停地打字**。」

busily = 正積極不停地進行工作或活動的方式

Important distinction: busy vs crowded

This matters especially in your sentence.

busy

= a lot of people **and/or activity**

> “The café was **busy**.”

「咖啡店**顧客很多, 而且各種活動都很頻繁**。」

crowded

= too many people/things for the available space

> “The café was **crowded**.”

「咖啡店裡**人很多, 可用空間不足, 顯得擠迫**。」

A café can be **busy without being crowded** if it is large enough.

Important distinction: **busy vs packed**

busy

Emphasizes **activity or demand**.

packed

Emphasizes **physical fullness and density**.

Compare your own phrase:

> “a **packed train**”

= 乘客多得幾乎佔滿所有空間

> “a **busy café**”

= 顧客和活動很多, 店內運作繁忙

So the writer chose these two words very precisely.

Important distinction: **busy vs occupied**

For a person, both can mean 「正在忙」, but:

busy

usually emphasizes having work or activities to do.

> “She’s busy with a customer.”

「她正在忙著處理顧客的事情。」

occupied

emphasizes that someone or something is currently in use or engaged.

> “This seat is occupied.”

「這個座位有人使用。」

We would normally **not** say:

> “This seat is busy.” ❌

Important distinction: **busy vs hectic**

busy

= a lot is happening

hectic

= so much is happening that the situation feels rushed, disorderly, or stressful

> “It was a busy morning.”

「早上很繁忙。」

> “It was a hectic morning.”

「早上**忙得非常急促混亂，令人有壓力**。」

So **hectic** is stronger and more stressful.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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busy person	有大量工作、任務或活動需要處理, 因此沒有多少空閒時間的
busy doing something	當時主要時間和注意力都用於進行某項活動
busy with something	時間和精力被某項工作或事情大量佔用
busy café/place	有很多顧客或訪客, 而且各種活動持續頻繁進行的
busy road/street	車輛或行人流量很大、交通活動頻繁的
busy period/day	某段時間內工作、需求或活動特別多的
busy schedule	安排了很多工作或活動, 空閒時間較少的
busy phone line	電話線正在被使用, 因此其他來電暫時無法接通的
busy server/device	正在處理其他工作或大量要求, 暫時沒有可用處理能力的
busy design/pattern	視覺元素、細節或顏色過多, 令畫面顯得太滿或雜亂的
busier / busiest	比較之下更加繁忙的／最繁忙的
busily	以不停工作或積極進行活動的方式

For your original phrase

> “a packed train, a ****busy**** café, and a noisy office”

The exact meaning is:

****busy = 一個地方有很多人及活動同時進行, 令整體運作十分繁忙****

So:

****a busy café = 一間顧客很多、員工不停服務、各種活動頻繁進行的繁忙咖啡店****

busybody = 愛管閒事、愛打聽別人私事的人

Meaning: A person who is excessively interested in other people's private affairs and often interferes or asks questions that are none of their business.

“She's such a busybody. She always wants to know what the neighbours are doing.”

「她真的很愛管閒事、愛打聽別人私事, 總想知道鄰居在做甚麼。」

“Ignore him—he's just a busybody who likes getting involved in everyone else's business.”

「別理他——他只是一個很愛插手別人事情的人, 甚麼都想管。」